

Mangia! Salsiccia

COOKING WITH SAUSAGE



A collection of recipes for sausage lovers
by award-winning third generation
master sausage-maker Ernie Ricci



For everyone who made this book possible.

A collection of recipes for sausage lovers, gathered from the Ricci family and friends.

Ernie's Introduction

The art of sausage-making has been a tradition in the Ricci family since 1945. Our fresh Italian sausage is made from 100% USDA inspected pork and imported spices. We don't do turkey and we don't do chicken, so don't ask. Natural casings are used on all of our rope sausage products. Sausage must contain some fat to be moist and flavorful, and our sausage contains just the right amount of fat - it's not greasy and it's not dry. To insure full and natural flavors, we never use cereal fillers, artificial spices, MSG, nitrates, or "designer" spices. Once you try Ricci's Italian Sausage products, you are experiencing the ultimate taste from a dedicated family using only the finest ingredients, committed to preserve that true Old World flavor.

For years, cooking sausage has always been an issue with customer's who visit our store. I pray for those customers who come in the store and tell my mother they are going to put our sausage in a crock pot and let it cook all day. Just thinking about what that does to our sausage gives me agita! Cooking with sausage is simple and the following pages will provide many options.

Dedication

It is an honor to dedicate this book to the memory of KDKA-AM 1020 radio personality, John Cigna. Long before the Food Network became popular on television, Cigna created the original Food Network on live radio! We want to share the art of cooking sausage; by using recipes created by local hometown Pittsburghers who love to eat. That was the beauty of Cigna, he was Pittsburgh and he loved to eat! All proceeds from this book will benefit John's favorite charity, The Little Sisters of the Poor. Throughout his career, John raised awareness for the Little Sisters with the help of the Cigna Riders and raised money for their mission, "to serve the poorest of the poor." For 135 years, they have dedicated their lives to caring for the elderly poor with dignity and respect. They have opened their hearts and their Home to care for more than 12,000 Pittsburghers regardless of race, or religion in this manner. All of the proceeds from the sales of this book will continue to support their mission

This digital edition preserves the dedication and historical charity reference. It does not represent a current charitable solicitation.

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Fat Tuesday Polenta

Ingredients and notes

- It is a tradition in our family to serve polenta with sausage on Fat Tuesday, the day before Ash Wednesday to prepare for the Lenten fast. The beauty of our Fat Tuesday Polenta feast is that we don't use dishes. The polenta is poured on a large cooking board placed on the top of the kitchen table. Everyone sits around the board with a fork and eats the polenta from their spot around the board. When our boys were young, Ernest and Gianni used to sit across from each other at the table and carve a path through the polenta to the other side – a wonderful memory! Since Ash Wednesday is a day of fast, our Fat Tuesday Polenta is topped with bite-sized portions of hot sausage.
- 1 pound of coarsely ground corn meal
- 2 quarts of boiling water
- Heavy tablespoon of salt
- Wooden spoon
- Sauce
- 3 pounds of hot sausage (rope)
- Grated parmesan cheese
- 1 Large cooking board

Directions

Par-boil the sausage in a ring for ten minutes. Poke some holes in the sausage with a fork during the process. Drain the sausage and cut into bite-sized pieces, and brown in a pan. Take the sausage and add it to your pot of favorite sauce.

Bring the 2 quarts of water to a boil in a large pot and add salt. Slowly add the corn meal – allow the water to continue to boil and stir with your wooden spoon. You must continue to stir the polenta until it is thick and creamy. Add additional boiling water as necessary and continue to stir the polenta. The polenta is done when it doesn't stick to the side of the pot.

Take the pot of polenta and pour it on your cooking board. With a spoon, spread the polenta on the board like a round pizza. Now, presentation is the most important part of this meal. If my late grandmother Stella taught us anything, it was presentation. The finished polenta must look like a picture! Spread the sauce on top of the polenta. Take each bite-sized piece of hot sausage and place it on top of the polenta. My grandmother made sure there was even space between each piece of sausage! Top the polenta with grated parmesan cheese – what a feast! Grab a fork; sit around the table, and Mangia!

— Lillian Ricci · Stella Ricci

Sausage Gravy and Biscuits

Ingredients and notes

- Our sweet Italian sausage makes good sausage gravy. Our sweet Italian sausage is from our home town of Sulmona (Abruzzo) and features coarse ground black pepper. For a modern touch, we add portobello mushrooms to the sauce and sun-dried tomatoes to biscuits. This was the first recipe we featured on QED Cooks, "B is for Brunch" on September 16, 2000.
- For the biscuits: 2 1/4 cups Bisquick Original Baking Mix 2/3 cup milk 2 tablespoons finely chopped sun-dried tomatoes, oil-pack

Directions

Preheat oven to 450 degrees. Stir ingredients together to form a soft dough. Drop by spoonfuls onto ungreased cookie sheet. Bake 8 to 10 minutes or until golden brown. Makes about 8-10 biscuits.

For the gravy: 2 pounds sweet Italian bulk sausage 1 large medium onion, chopped 1/2 pound portobello mushrooms, thinly sliced 2 1/2 cups canned evaporated milk 1/3 cup Wondra flour

Sauté sausage and onion in a large skillet until well-browned. Place the sausage in a strainer set over a bowl to collect the drippings.

Pour 1/4 cup of the drippings back into the skillet. Add the mushrooms and cook until soft, about 5 minutes. Stir in the flour and cook, stirring until lightly golden, about 2 minutes. Gradually stir in the milk using a whisk until thickened. Add the drained sausage and heat through.

To serve: Split the biscuits in half and set the bottoms on dinner-size plates. Top generously with the sausage gravy and biscuit tops. Makes 4 to 6 servings.

— Ernie & Sherry Ricci · Ricci's Italian Sausage · QED Cooks · B is for Brunch — September 16, 2000

Stella's Hot Sausage With Sauce

Ingredients and notes

- This recipe was featured on QED Cooks, "What Pittsburgh Eats!" on October 14, 2006. Stella is my grandmother, who was an amazing cook. This is her simple hot sausage recipe.
- 5 lb box Ricci's Hot Italian Sausage
- 2 large cans (32 oz.) of Italian plum tomatoes, with basil
- 3 large green bell peppers
- 1 large sweet onion

Directions

Sauté sliced onions and peppers in olive oil until translucent. Add salt, pepper and garlic powder to taste.

Chop and blend in a blender, 2 cans (lg) of Italian plum tomatoes, one can at a time. Add whole basil to the sauce.

Stir blended tomatoes into the pot of peppers and onions.

Prepare sausage – Par-boil sausage in a ring in a large pot for approximately ten minutes and poke holes in the sausage with a fork. Drain and cut the sausage into 4"pieces. Brown the sausage pieces lightly in a frying pan - then add to sauce. (add some of the sausage drippings)

Cook on medium to low heat for about an hour until the sauce acquires a "good taste." For a sweeter taste, you may add sugar to the sauce.

— Stella Ricci · Ricci's Italian Sausage

Lil's Sweet Italian Sausage with Peppers and Onions

Ingredients and notes

- This is a great sweet Italian sausage recipe. One customer who really enjoyed our sweet Italian sausage was WTAE meteorologist Joe DeNardo. Joe has been eating our sweet Italian sausage for almost 40 years! This is a great recipe which my mother sent to Joe at the station in the early 80's.
- 5 lb. box Ricci's sweet Italian sausage
- A medley of red, yellow and green bell peppers
- 1 large sweet onion
- 1 container of portabella mushrooms
- 1 stick of butter
- White cooking wine

Directions

Sauté' sliced peppers and onions in butter until translucent. Add salt, pepper and garlic powder to taste.

Sauté portabella mushrooms in butter/wine

Prepare sausage - Boil sausage "RING" in a large pot for approximately ten minutes and poke holes in sausage with a fork.

Drain and cut the sausage into "bite-sized" pieces and brown. Add browned sausage to the bell peppers, onions and mushroom mix. Cook on low heat for 45 minutes, stir occasionally. This is a great appetizer!

— Remember – "Joe says it's good!" · Lil Ricci · Ricci's Italian Sausage

Ernie's Stuffed Hot Banana Peppers

Ingredients and notes

- Banana peppers stuffed with hot Italian sausage is a real Pittsburgh dish! I love it when customers ask, "Are the peppers hot?" I sure hope so! The recipe is simple and don't skimp on the sausage. The next time you visit Fat Heads in South Side or Bocktown Beer and Grill in Robinson Township or Monaca or Downey's House in Robinson, order some of Ernie's Peppers!
- Ricci's Italian hot sausage, bulk
- Large, straight, hot banana peppers (If in season, visit Sonny at Janoski's in Clinton)
- Grated Parmesan cheese

Directions

Carefully remove the stem from the top of the pepper. If you can smell the "heat" from the peppers, wear plastic gloves or a mask. Please, don't touch your lips, mouth or eyes while you are cleaning the peppers! Clean the inside of the peppers, but leave in some of the seeds. Mix in the Parmesan cheese with the bulk hot sausage. When you bake the peppers in sauce, the cheese will add flavor.

When we stuff peppers, we use our sausage stuffer and place the tip of the pepper to the end of the horn and stuff clean to the end. We cap the sausage on the end of the pepper like a snow cone. Remember, presentation is everything!

If you stuffed a large amount of peppers, place them on a tray and freeze. Once frozen, you can keep the peppers in a freezer bag for future use. They will come in handy when the Steelers are in the playoffs in January! For cooking, place the peppers in a pan, cover with sauce and bake at 350 degrees for about 45 minutes. If you use a thermometer, the internal temperature of your largest pepper should be 160 degrees. For an extra touch, once cooked, top the peppers with melted mozzarella cheese.

Now, eat the peppers, dip your bread in the sauce, and if their hot enough, your eyes will water and you will break a good sweat! MANGIA!

Ernie Ricci

The Primadonna Restaurant was western Pennsylvania's premier and top rated Italian restaurant for nearly three decades. Owner, Joseph Costanzo, Jr. revolutionized fine dining Italian cuisine. Two of the most popular dishes at the Primadonna were sausage dishes made with Ricci's Italian sausage. They were Spaghetti Con Sausage and Sausage Cheese Chowder. With permission, Joseph Costanzo, Jr. has released these fabulous recipes for everyone to enjoy!

Sausage Cheese Chowder

Ingredients and notes

- ¼ cup unsalted butter
- ½ cup onions, diced
- 1-cup carrots, diced
- 1-cup celery, diced
- ½ cup green bell peppers, diced
- 1-pound Ricci's loose hot sausage
- Salt and freshly ground black pepper to taste
- ¼ cup all-purpose flour
- 4 cups chicken broth
- 10 slices American cheese
- 1-teaspoon paprika
- 1 cup scalded milk
- 1 (10-ounce) can sweet corn, drained
- 1 teaspoon fresh parsley, minced for garnish

Directions

In a large soup pot, melt the butter and sauté the onions, carrots, celery, green peppers, and hot sausage until the sausage is nearly cooked through.

Season with salt and pepper, then drain off the oil from the sausage. Over medium heat, stir in the flour and add the chicken broth; stir until thickened. Add the cheese, paprika and milk; mix well. Add the drained corn and continue heating (do not boil). Season with salt and pepper to taste. Divide into 6-8 soup bowls, garnish with parsley and serve immediately.

— Joseph Costanzo, Jr, Owner · Primadonna Restaurant · Winner of the DiRona Award

Spaghetti Con Sausage

Ingredients and notes

- Spaghetti with sweet green peppers, onions and Ricci's homemade ground hot sausage in a rich tomato sauce.

Directions

Sauté one pound of Ricci's homemade loose hot sausage until cooked then drain the grease.

Sauté one sliced green pepper and one sliced Spanish onion until tender.

Add chopped garlic and season with salt and pepper to taste.

Combine sausage with the sautéed peppers and onions and add two cups of rich tomato sauce.

Prepare 1 pound spaghetti, cooked al dente and drain

Toss spaghetti with the sausage, green peppers and onions in the tomato sauce.

— Garnish with Parmesan cheese · Joseph Costanzo, Jr., Owner · Primadonna Restaurant · Winner of the DiRona Award

Orecchiette Barese

Ingredients and notes

- This pasta is named after the town of Bari, a coastal town on the Adriatic Sea in the Puglia region of Italy. The famous Saint Nicholas, after whom the modern Santa Claus was founded, was bishop of Bari in the 4th century. The orecchiette, or little ear pasta makes this a fun dish, and the fresh greens make it perfect for a spring or summer dinner.
- 1 pound orecchiette
- ½ pound loose sweet Italian sausage
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 1 clove garlic, minced
- 1 bunch rapini (or broccoli di rape), chopped
- 1 cup red wine
- Olive oil
- Salt
- 1 tsp. coarse ground black pepper
- ¼ tsp. crushed red pepper (optional)
- Pecorino Romano

Directions

Put pasta water on to boil in a large pot.

In a frying pan heat 1 tsp. olive oil over medium heat. Crumble sausage in pan and cook until brown. Remove from pan and drain grease. Set sausage aside.

In the same frying pan heat 1 Tbsp. olive oil over medium heat. Add onion and garlic and cook until brown. Add rapini and cook until it wilts. Add sausage back to pan, along with 1 tsp. salt, black pepper, and, if you prefer, crushed red pepper flakes, and red wine and continue to cook over medium heat.

Add 1 Tbsp. of salt to boiling pasta water. Add pasta and cook according to directions on package.

When wine cooks off of sausage and rapini mixture turn heat to low.

When pasta is ready, reserve 1 cup of pasta water and drain pasta. **DO NOT RINSE PASTA!** Return pasta to large pot and add sausage and rapini mixture. Stir, adding only enough reserved pasta water until the mixture coats the pasta, usually about ¼ to ½ cup.

— Top with pecorino Romano and enjoy · Fr. Nick Vaskov

Risotto with Sweet Italian Sausage and Portobello Mushrooms

Ingredients and notes

- We featured this recipe in the QED Cooks kitchen at the Pittsburgh Home & Garden Show in March 2003. The Pittsburgh Home and Garden Show was always a great place to introduce recipes.
- 1lb. Ricci's Italian loose sweet sausage
- 1 cup of Arborio rice
- Quart of your favorite marinara sauce
- 1 container of baby portabella mushrooms (sliced)
- 1 teaspoon chopped garlic
- 1 tablespoon concentrated chicken soup base, (the kind that's in a plastic jar that is pasty)
- 2 tablespoon olive oil
- ½ cup of wine
- 1 cup of grated Romano or parmesan cheese

Directions

Place 1 tablespoon of olive oil, sausage and garlic in large pan. Sauté on medium, pulling apart and browning sausage into small pieces.

Add wine, then mushrooms and simmer until mushrooms are tender.

Heat marinara sauce in a pot and add mushroom mixture. Simmer on low, stirring occasionally.

In another pot, place 1 T olive oil and the rice. Heat and stir continually on medium until translucent.

Add 2 cups of water and chicken base. Bring to a boil then turn heat down to a slow boil, stirring to prevent rice from sticking. Add more water as needed until rice is tender enough to your tasting.

With a slotted spoon, scoop out rice and place into a large enough pot to accommodate 2/3 sauce and rice. Add sauce, and stir thoroughly.

Cook on low, stirring to prevent sticking until all liquid is soaked up but still moist.

Stir in Romano cheese and place in a serving bowl.

Serve with the remaining sauce for topping.

— Sherry Ricci · Ricci's Italian Sausage

Sherry's Roasted Red Pepper Pasta Sauce with Sweet Italian Sausage

Ingredients and notes

- This is my signature pasta sauce, which tastes like you slaved all day in the kitchen but it is so simple to make. We recommend serving over farfalle or pappardelle pasta.
- 1 jar of roasted red pepper spread.
- 1 lb. of Ricci's Italian loose sweet sausage
- 1 container of slice baby portabella mushrooms
- 2 pints of light cream
- Wondra flour
- 1 tablespoon of olive oil
- ½ cup of grated parmesan or Romano cheese

Directions

Brown sausage in pan coated with olive oil by pulling apart into small pieces.

Stir in portabella mushrooms. Turn temperature down on low.

Add pepper spread. Fill empty jar half way with water. Swish around sides to grab any remainder spread and pour into pan with mixture.

Simmer for 20 minutes, stirring occasionally to prevent burning.

Take off burner and gradually add cream, while continually stirring.

Put back on burner and add cheese and sprinkle flour while using a whisk.

Sauce will thicken.

— Pour over favorite pasta and serve · Sherry Ricci · Ricci's Italian Sausage

Sausage Burgundy Stuffed Mushrooms

Ingredients and notes

- If you have ever been to Wexford, you have seen T-Bones Marketplace located off the Wexford exit on the corner of VIP Drive and Rt. 910. Tom Weir and his staff have been serving the customers in the North Hills with some of the most creative prepared recipes since 1985.
- 12-Large Mushroom Caps, Cleaned and Stems Removed
- 1 lb. Ricci's Italian Hot Sausage (bulk)
- 1 tsp. Chopped Garlic
- 1 TBLSP. Chopped Parsley
- ¼ Cup Burgundy Wine
- ¼ Cup Heavy Cream
- 1/3 Cup Dried Bread Crumbs
- ½ Cup Romano Cheese
- Salt & Pepper to taste

Directions

MIX all ingredients – except mushrooms. Mix Well. If mixture is too moist, add more bread crumbs. TRIM bottom of mushrooms so that they sit flat. STUFF mushrooms with sausage mixture. SPRAY cookie sheet with PAM Spray and PLACE mushrooms on sheet evenly.

BAKE at 350 Degrees for 25-30 minutes - TURN sheet around at half way point to bake evenly.

— Meg Wendel · T-Bone's Marketplace · Wexford, PA

Eggplant Parmesan Rollatini With Hot Italian Sausage

Ingredients and notes

- 4 large teaspoons olive oil
- 2 large eggplants (about 3 lbs. total), sliced lengthwise (about 16 slices total)
- 1 lb. Ricci's Italian Hot Sausage, ground, or as we call it "loose"
- Kosher salt and coarsely ground black pepper
- 1 ½ cups of your favorite marina sauce
- 2 large eggs
- 1 15 ounce container ricotta cheese
- 2 teaspoon if fresh chopped parsley
- 2 cups grated mozzarella (8 ounces)
- ½ cup grated Parmesan or Romano (1 ½ ounces)

Directions

Heat oven to 450 degrees F. Divide the oil between 2 rimmed baking sheets. Dividing evenly, arrange the eggplant slices in a single layer on the baking sheets and turn to coat in the oil; season with ½ teaspoon salt and ¼ teaspoon pepper.

Bake the eggplant, rotating the baking sheets halfway through, until soft and beginning to brown, 12 to 15 minutes; let cool. Reduce heat to 400 degrees F.

While eggplant is baking, brown sausage in pan with olive oil on medium heat. Separate into small pieces while cooking until brown. Drain and set aside.

In the bottom of a 9 by 13 inch baking dish spread ½ cup of the marina sauce.

In a large bowl, whisk together the eggs, ricotta cheese, parsley, salt and pepper. Fold in mozzarella cheese and sausage, and mix thoroughly.

Place about 3 tablespoons of the mixture on one end of a slice of eggplant, roll it up, and transfer it to the prepared baking dish. Repeat with the remaining eggplant slices and ricotta mixture.

Top the eggplant rolls with the remaining marinara sauce and the remaining mozzarella. Sprinkle with the Parmesan or Romano cheese.

Bake until the cheese has melted and the sauce is bubbling, 20 to 25 minutes. Let cool for 5 minutes before serving.

— Sherry Ricci · Ricci's Italian Sausage

Zucchini Boats

Ingredients and notes

- 1 pound Ricci's hot sausage loose
- 4 medium sized Zucchini
- Bread Crumbs
- Garlic—about 4 cloves minced
- Grated pecorino Romano cheese
- Ricci's Arrabiata sauce ("It's a little bit angry")

Directions

Cut zucchinis in half lengthwise. Prepare a baking pan by lining it with foil, and spraying the foil with Pam. Place zucchini on the foil, and place a few drops of olive oil on each zucchini half. Bake for 10 minutes at 450, flip the zucchini over and bake for another 10 minutes at 450. When you take them out, you want them to be tender so that the inside of the zucchini can be scooped out with a spoon. Take all of the zucchini that you have scooped out and place it in a mixing bowl, along with grated pecorino Romano, bread crumbs, garlic, and browned hot sausage. The sausage can be browned while the zucchini is baking, or prior to. Be sure to use olive oil, and keep the oil to use in the mixture. Mix everything in the bowl adding enough olive oil and bread crumbs to create a filling that is solid and sticks together. Spoon the mixture into the emptied out zucchini boats, filling them up. Sprinkle a little grated pecorino Romano over each boat. Bake the refilled zucchini boats at 400, for about 5-7 minutes. You want the top of the filling to brown. These can be served as is, or with some Arrabiata sauce spooned over the zucchini boat and a little cheese sprinkled on top of that.

— Antonia Alaimo · Kutztown, PA

Hot Sausage Mozzarella Roll

Ingredients and notes

- Great tailgate recipe! Go Steelers
- 2-1 pound loaves of bread dough (frozen or fresh Mancini's)
- 1 large sweet onion, chopped
- 2 pounds hot Italian sausage, bulk, chopped
- 8 oz. Mozzarella cheese, shredded
- ¼ cup fresh parsley, chopped
- 1 egg yolk beaten
- ½ cut grated Parmesan cheese

Directions

Dough, (fresh or frozen) should be at room temperature. Cook sausage and onion in a large skillet – continue to chop sausage until cooked. Drain and place sausage and cooked onions to a dish and place in refrigerator to cool.

On a floured surface, pat out one piece of dough and roll into a rectangle, about 14x9 inches. Sprinkle with half of the sausage mixture, cheese and parsley. Roll up dough (long side) and pretend you are making a nut roll.

Place roll, seam side down, to a lightly greased cookie sheet and tuck the ends under. Continue with the same process with the remaining mixture. Please the rolls several inches apart on the cookie sheet and brush with the egg yolk and sprinkle the grated Parmesan cheese.

Bake in a 375 degree oven for 30 minutes or until the crust is brown. Remove loaves to a platter, cut into slices, dip in your favorite sauce, drink, and wave your Terrible Towel while you cheer on the Pittsburgh Steelers!

— Anonymous Steelers Fan

Rigatoni Alla Norcina

Ingredients and notes

- This pasta is named after the town of Norcia, a mountain town in the Umbria region of Italy. Known for its pork products, especially sausages and salamis, Norcia is the birth place of Saint Benedict, founder of the Benedictine order of monks. This rich and creamy pasta is always is great for the fall and winter seasons.
- 1 pound rigatoni
- ½ pound loose sweet Italian sausage
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 1 cup mushrooms, chopped (optional)
- 2 cups heavy cream
- ½ cup grated pecorino Romano, plus cheese to top
- Olive oil
- Salt
- 1 tsp. coarse ground black pepper
- ¼ tsp. crushed red pepper (optional)

Directions

Put pasta water on to boil in a large pot.

In a frying pan heat 1 tsp. olive oil over medium heat. Crumble sausage in pan and cook until brown. Remove from pan and drain grease. Set sausage aside.

In the same frying pan heat 1 tsp. olive oil over medium heat. Add onion and, if you prefer, mushrooms, and cook until brown. Add sausage back to pan, along with ½ tsp. salt, black pepper, and, if you prefer, crushed red pepper flakes and continue to cook.

Add 1 Tbsp. of salt to boiling pasta water. Add pasta and cook according to directions on package.

While pasta is cooking, add heavy cream and pecorino Romano to the sausage mixture. When cream begins to simmer, turn heat to low and continue to cook.

When pasta is ready, reserve 1 cup of pasta water and drain pasta. **DO NOT RINSE PASTA!** Return pasta to large pot and add sausage and cream mixture. Stir, adding only enough reserved pasta water until desired creaminess is attained, usually about ¼ cup.

Top with pecorino Romano and enjoy!

— Fr. Nick Vaskov

It's A Man's World Meatloaf!

Ingredients and notes

- Double recipe because you will want leftovers for sandwiches the next day.
- 2 pounds ground meat (90% lean)
- 1 pound Ricci's ground hot sausage
- 1 minced onion
- ½ chopped parsley
- ½ jar Delmonte chili sauce
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp. pepper
- 1 tsp. salt
- ½ cup unflavored breadcrumbs

Directions

Mix thoroughly, shape into meatloaf pan. Bake one hour at 350 degrees. Remove. Let cool and discard the drippings. In a heavy saucepan, slice a large sweet onion and sauté in 2 T olive oil.

— Slice meatloaf, top with onion and serve with extra chili sauce on the side · Betsy Andreini · Wheeling, WVA

Pasta With Sausage, Bell Peppers & Basil

Ingredients and notes

- The right color and presentation always adds to the taste of food! Try this simple pasta recipe with a colorful pepper medley.
- ¼ cup extra virgin olive oil
- 3 pounds hot Italian sausage, bulk, crumbled
- 5 cups sweet sliced onions
- 1 red, 1 yellow bell pepper (large)
- 2 pounds fusilli pasta (substitute any other short pasta you enjoy)
- 1 cup dry white wine
- 1 ½ cup grated Parmesan
- 2 cups sliced fresh basil
- Extra grated Parmesan

Directions

You need 2 heavy large skillets – and divide the olive oil in each skillet. On medium heat, cook the sausage - in each skillet, until brown and chop – about 12 minutes.

Remove sausage, place in large bowl and keep the natural juice in each skillet. Add equal amount of onions to each skillet and sauté until brown. Now add pepper medley to each skillet with onions and sauté until tender. Add equal amounts of wine to each skillet, boil about 5 minutes, allow wine to evaporate a bit and add vegetables to the sausage.

In a large pot, boil your pasta until al dente. Drain pasta and place back into large pot and add the sausage, vegetable and all of the juice and toss. Now add the Parmesan cheese and basil and toss again. Place in large bowl and add basil to top and serve with additional grated cheese.

— Anonymous - Pittsburgh

Potatoes and Sweet Italian Sausage With Some Parsley!

Ingredients and notes

- 3 ½ pounds of russet potatoes, peel and cut into 1-inch pieces
- 3 tablespoons of fresh parsley (chopped)
- 2 sweet onions cut into 1 inch pieces
- 2 pounds Ricci's sweet Italian sausage – rope
- 4 bacon slices, chop into coarse pieces
- 1 can beef broth (14 ounce can)

Directions

For best results – slightly par-boil the sweet Italian sausage (5 minutes) drain and cut into bite-sized pieces.

Place potatoes in the bottom of a large, heavy saucepan and sprinkle with 1 tablespoon of the fresh parsley. Top with onions and sprinkle 1 tablespoon of fresh parsley. Now add the sausage and the bacon and pour over the beef broth and lightly season with some coarse ground black pepper and bring mixture to a boil over high heat and cover the pan. Reduce to medium-low heat, simmer until potatoes are tender and sausage is cooked. Usually takes about 30 minutes.

Uncover the pan and continue to boil until the liquids are slightly reduced, about 5 minutes. Sprinkle with the remaining parsley.

Anonymous Irish cook. Note: If you cook with wine, it is OK to drink wine while cooking. It always makes the process much happier.....

Sausage Frittata

Ingredients and notes

- This is a great recipe from Chef Mari Romano, at Juliano's Restaurant, Robinson Township. The Scalise family has been friends and customers since they opened their restaurant in 1978. In a true family tradition, Chef Mari and Nick Scalise sent the recipe and a sausage frittata for everyone to enjoy – delicious!
- 1-½ dozen eggs
- 1/8 c Romano cheese
- Salt and Pepper to taste
- 2-6 inch Ricci's sausage links (hot or sweet) fully cooked and chopped in chunks
- ½ c cooked green peppers
- ½ c cooked onions
- Preheat oven to 450 degrees

Directions

Coat the bottom of a nonstick oven safe pan with oil. Add peppers, onions, and sausage and sauté until hot. In a bowl, beat eggs until fluffy and add Romano cheese, salt and pepper. Add egg mixture to pan. Reduce heat to medium. Cook for about 5 to 10 minutes until eggs are cooked half way thru. While cooking, continuously loosen eggs from the sides of the pan with a spatula. One Frittata is half way done, cover with a lid and put it into the oven to bank. Cook another 10 minutes or until the center is completely cooked.

Let it cook for 5 minutes and loosen eggs from side of the pan again. Top pan with a plate and flip Frittata over. Sprinkle with your favorite cheese and/or parsley. Enjoy!

— Chef Mari Romano · Juliano's Restaurant · Robinson Township

Sweet Sausage & Potato Breakfast Casserole

Ingredients and notes

- 1 pound sweet Italian sausage, bulk, crumbled
- 2 tablespoons all purpose flour
- 1 ½ cups of milk – Real milk, not low fat
- 1 pound bag of frozen shredded hash brown potatoes
- 1 ¼ cups grated sharp cheddar cheese

Directions

Preheat oven to 350 degrees and butter 8 x 8 x 2 inch glass baking dish

Cook sausage in heavy large skilled with some water, chop into small pieces on medium heat until done. Mix in flour, then milk. Cook entire mixture until it thickens and comes to a boil. Continue to stir for about 5 minutes.

Arrange potatoes in the buttered baking dish and top with 1 cup of cheese, sausage mixture and the remaining cheese.

Bake casserole until potatoes are tender, about 45 minutes and serve.

— Anonymous – Pittsburgh, PA

Sausage and Grapes

Ingredients and notes

- It's simple! Just sausage and grapes, ha-ha no measuring needed, it's an Italian dish.
- I mean what Italian measures anything?
- Sweet Italian Sausage
- Green seedless grapes
- White wine

Directions

Take mild/sweet sausage. Cut into 1-2 inch chunks. Brown in a frying pan with no oil. Once brown add 1 or 2 handfuls of green seedless grapes and a splash or two of a white wine. Work the browned juice and wine in together and cook until grapes are hot but still firm.

Simple – Mangia!

— Anthony Domenic Roppa · Sewickley and Southside

Johnna's Breakfast Casserole

Ingredients and notes

- Thanks for inviting me to provide a sausage recipe for the cookbook. I have a small problem, though. I'm an Italian woman; I don't use a recipe! My breakfast casserole recipe goes something like this: Fry up some ground sausage. While that's cooking, mix up eggs, milk, dry mustard, cheese, croutons and a smidge of salt & pepper. Drain sausage well. Add it to the egg mixture. Pour in a greased casserole dish and cover; refrigerate overnight. Take out in the morning, uncover and bake. What kind of sausage? Ricci's, of course. How many eggs? Maybe 9, maybe 12 (depends on the size of your casserole dish). What about the croutons? I don't know; enough to make a solid layer. How much cheese and what kind? Whatever is in the refrigerator or a mix up everything you have. (Anything good tastes better with cheese!) How long do you bake it? 'Til it's done!
- OK. Here's the real recipe
- 9 eggs 1 lb. Ricci's Sausage, crumbled, browned and drained 1 1/2 cups shredded cheddar cheese (or your favorite cheese) 1 bag plain or seasoned croutons (or 12 slices bread, cubed) 1 tsp dry mustard Salt and pepper to taste 3 cups milk MIX: eggs, milk and spices FOLD IN: bread and Cheese POUR into a greased 9x13 pan Sprinkle sausage on top Cover and refrigerate overnite

Directions

In the morning, remove from refrigerator and let sit while oven heats to 350 degrees. Remove cover and bake for 60 to 70 minutes. (Test by inserting a knife; if it comes out clean, the casserole is done). The casserole will puff up while baking. The croutons will form a crust on the bottom and the sausage will float to the top. SERVE for breakfast or brunch with fresh fruit and muffins.

NOTE: Depending on the size of your casserole dish, you can adjust the ingredients. I like to make sure there is a nice solid layer of sausage and of bread; you can never have too much cheese; and an extra egg or two won't hurt! This recipe will reheat nicely the next day

— JOHNNA PRO · KDKA NEWS RADIO 1020

Simple Red Sauce with Sausage

Ingredients and notes

- Used with permission from Tomatoes Garlic Basil by Doug Oster, KDKA's co-host of The Organic Gardeners and The Pittsburgh Post-Gazette's Backyard Gardener
- Sauces don't get any easier than this, and they don't get much better either. This one's bound to be a trusty stand-by for almost any occasion, but it's especially good for summer. This simple recipe uses the best and freshest ingredients from the garden.
- Take special note of Chef Donato Coluccio's exploding garlic technique. He taught me this and now I use it for most of my garlic dishes. (Donato runs his own restaurant in Fox Chapel called Donato's.
- 4 tablespoons good-quality olive oil
- ½ cup chicken stock
- 8 large garden tomatoes, with seeds and peels, cubed
- ½ pound of cooked hot Italian sausage
- 1 cup chopped basil
- Salt and pepper, to taste

Directions

Heat two tablespoons of good olive oil on medium high heat. Slice 5 garlic cloves, and mince the other 5. Add the sliced garlic cloves to the oil and cook for a minute. Then add the minced garlic cloves and cook for another 30 seconds. Immediately add the cold chicken stock – this stops the garlic from cooking any longer. Now, I don't peel my tomatoes or remove the seeds. I think they're an important addition to a summer sauce, and good in other uses too.

Lower the heat, add the cubed tomatoes and cook for 5 minutes. Remove from heat and add a cup of chopped basil and the sausage. Add salt and pepper to taste and you have an easy, delicious red sauce.

— Doug Oster · Staff Writer/Videographer · Pittsburgh Post-Gazette

Sausage N' Cheese Grits Casserole

Ingredients and notes

- 4 cups water
- 1 tsp salt
- 1 cup enriched quick grits
- 4 eggs, slightly beaten
- 1 pound sausage, browned
- 1½ cups (6 oz) shredded sharp cheese
- 1 cup milk
- ¼ cup butter or margarine

Directions

Preheat oven to 350 degrees. Grease a 3-quart baking dish, set aside.

Bring water and salt to a boil in medium size pan.

Slowly stir in the grits and cook 4-5 minutes, stirring occasionally.

Remove pan from heat.

Stir in small amounts of the Grits into the eggs, return to pan.

Add sausage, 1 cup of cheese, milk and butter, blend well.

Pour mixture into baking dish.

Sprinkle remaining cheese on top.

Bake for 1 hour, or until cheese is golden brown.

Allow casserole to cool 10 minutes before serving.

— Ruth Nagy, Managing Director · AAA Travel · Member, Pratte Pack

Sausage and Peppers

Ingredients and notes

- Disclaimer: I am Italian, so I cook ad' occhio! (with my eye, no measurements)
- Sausage – Hot or Sweet in the casing
- Red Peppers – sliced
- Red Skin Potatoes

Directions

Add some olive oil, salt, and sausage to a baking pan. Bake the sausage for 20 minutes at 400 degrees. Then add the potatoes (you can cut them in half or in slices) and red peppers (also sliced). Continue to bake until everything is cooked thoroughly. Put a fork through the potatoes to see if they are cooked and the peppers you can tell if they are ready by the color.

— Maria Alaimo · Naples, Florida

Sausage Garbanzo Soup

Ingredients and notes

- Bocktown Beer and Grill in Robinson Township and Monaca promote Pittsburgh Pride and use many local vendors. We want to thank Chef Michael Tollis and Chris Dilla for this great recipe.
- 1 tsp olive oil
- 1# Ricci's loose hot sausage
- 2 stalks chopped celery with leaves
- 1 carrot finely diced
- ½ onion finely diced
- 6 garlic cloves chopped
- 1 cup canned diced and peeled tomatoes
- 1 cup par boiled and diced redskin potatoes
- 3 oz. red wine
- ½ tsp red pepper flakes
- 1 tsp chopped fresh rosemary
- 3 15 oz. cans undrained garbanzo beans
- 2 cups beef broth

Directions

Heat olive oil; add carrots and sauté until tender add celery and onions. Cook until vegetables start to brown and add garlic, stir once, deglaze pot with red wine and add sausage.

Cook sausage for 5-6 minutes until it is browned evenly. Add tomatoes, potatoes, red pepper flakes and rosemary. Simmer for 10-12 minutes. Stir frequently. Add garbanzo beans and beef broth, simmer for 15 minutes. Season soup with salt and pepper to taste. Ladle soup into bowls and garnish with fresh grated Pecorino Romano and crusty bread.

— Chef Michael Tollis · Bocktown Beer and Grill · Robinson · Monaca

Potato And Sausage Falagone

Ingredients and notes

- Falagone is a tradition dating back to when the Ripoli family first immigrated to the US. They are made as a tradition during the Easter Holiday. You can make them with many different fillings but the most popular is the potato and sausage!
- First the dough recipe:
- 10 cups of flour
- 1 cup of oil
- 3 cups of water
- 1 tbsp. of salt

Directions

Mix the dough into a ball and then cut it into 10 - 12 small (equal size) balls. Put them in the refrigerator as they are easier to use cooled.

The inside mixture includes:

Unfortunately there are no set amounts as this was handed down through the generations it was just mixed to each person's liking of how much of each ingredient is used. I have put them in order of most to least used in our family.

Sliced Potatoes

Cooked loose sausage (drained well)

Sliced onions

Diced hot yellow banana peppers

Oil (just so the mixture is lightly coated)

Salt (enough to your liking)

Paprika (enough to your liking)

Grated Romano or Parmesan cheese

Mix this all in a bowl and put aside.

Now you roll out 1 dough ball to form a circle to about 1/4 inch thickness then you get a handful of your filling mixture, squeeze out the oil through your fingers, and lay it on the top half of your dough circle. Then you fold the bottom half up and fold and flute the edges of the dough so as to close it and now it looks like half a moon. Then you poke a few fork holes through the top to let the heat escape when you bake them. Put 2 on a greased cookie sheet and bake on 350 degrees until the dough is golden brown. Approximately 20 minutes. Put on a cooling rack for 15 minutes, slice and serve.

— Phyllis (Rippole) Barbaro and the Rippole Family · Norwood (McKees Rocks) Pennsylvania

Sausage and Potatoes

Ingredients and notes

- 1 pound of raw hot or sweet sausage cut in 3 inch pieces
- 2 green or red peppers
- 1 large onion, sliced
- 4 potatoes sliced
- Optional:
- 1 can of dice tomatoes

Directions

Mix all together in baking dish; add $\frac{1}{4}$ cup of water, cover with foil and bake at 350 for 1 hour or until sausage and potatoes are cooked through.

Enjoy!

— Vince & Vera DelBrocco · Moon Township, PA

Italian Greens & Beans With Sausage

Ingredients and notes

- This was one of Cigna's favorites! He would eat this dish while doing the show at 6:00AM! There are many versions of this great dish and this is a great recipe.
- 1 large head of fresh escarole or 1 large bag of baby spinach
- 1 half cup olive oil
- 1 medium onion, sliced
- 4 cloves garlic, sliced
- 1 fresh tomato, chopped
- 1 pound Italian hot or sweet sausage, remove from casing, cooked and crumbled
- 1 16 ounce can cannellini beans
- 1 cup water or chicken stock
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Optional:
- Crushed hot pepper
- Grated parmesan cheese

Directions

Clean and rinse escarole or spinach. Chop onions and garlic, sauté in skillet with olive oil. Add chopped fresh tomato and continue to sauté until tomato is soft. Add browned sausage, reduce heat and allow to simmer about 15 minutes. Add the beans and salt and pepper. Add the escarole and place lid tightly on pan.

Once escarole is wilted and tender, stir well. Add chicken stock let the whole mixture simmer for 10 minutes. Add crushed hot pepper and sprinkle with grated parmesan cheese.

Bon Appétit!

— Vera and Vince DelBrocco · Moon Township, PA

Antoniette's Lasagna

Ingredients and notes

- My friend Toni Barbuto is an amazing cook. Everything she prepares is a masterpiece. I hope you enjoy this trying recipe as much as I enjoyed eating it! Move over Gada De Laurentis and the Barefoot Contessa, Toni will out cook you in every category!

Directions

1 or 2 boxes Barilla Lasagna noodles-cooked al dente 3 lb Lamgana Ricotta 30 miniature meatballs, half-baked Equal parts veal-pork-beef /add eggs-parsley-bread crumbs-seasoning- form meatballs and Bake in oven (350 oven) Ricci's hot sausage -sautéed and grilled slightly- sliced - need about 25-30slices Mozzarella shredded cheese Good tomato sauces- meat or marinara

Directions Coat bottom of lasagna dish with sauce-line with ricotta-evenly place meatballs and sausage in ricotta-save half for next layer-drizzle sauce and scatter with mozzarella. Start another layer with pasta- sauce ricotta-meatballs-sausage-sauce and Mozzarella. Place another layer of pasta sauce and sprinkle parmesan cheese. Place another layer of pasta on top (this will be discarded after baking)

Bake at 350 oven for 1 hour- let sit covered to cool slightly. Enjoy!

— Antoniette Barbuto · Aliquippa, PA

Spaghetti Pizza

Ingredients and notes

- 1 lb spaghetti
- 1 cup milk
- 1 cup mozzarella cheese
- $\frac{3}{4}$ tsp garlic powder
- $\frac{1}{2}$ tsp salt
- 2 eggs

Directions

Preheat oven to 400° Break spaghetti into 2" pieces. Cook and drain. Beat eggs, milk and all other above ingredients. Then mix in cooked spaghetti. Spray oblong lasagna dish and spread – bake for 15 minutes.

1 lb of loose Italian sausage (hot or sweet)

32 oz tomato sauce

Cook loose sausage and drain. Put in sauce and heat a few minutes.

Reduce oven to 350°

Place on top of layer of spaghetti. Put 2 cups mozzarella on top of sauce

Top with 16 slices of thin pepperoni. Bake for 30 minutes at 350 – let stand for 5 minutes before cutting!

— Toni R. Mastrullo · Deerfield Beach, Florida

Mushrooms Stuffed With Sweet Sausage

Ingredients and notes

- 24 large fresh mushrooms
- 4 tablespoons of olive oil
- ½ cup of chopped onion
- 1 tablespoon of minced garlic
- ½ pound of sweet sausage
- ¼ cup of dried bread crumbs
- 1 cup of chicken stock
- Salt and pepper to taste

Directions

Remove the stems from the mushrooms and chop them; reserve the caps. Heat 2 tablespoons of the oil in a large sauté pan. Add the chopped onion and cook until soft, about 5 minutes. Add the chopped stems and cook over high heat until they start to become dry, about 5 minutes. Stir in the garlic and cook for 1 minute. Transfer to a bowl and set aside.

Heat the remaining 2 tablespoons of oil in the same pan. Cook the sausage, breaking it up with a fork, until it is no longer pink. Stir in the cooked mushroom and onion mixture and the bread crumbs; mix well. Season with salt and pepper.

Preheat the oven to 350 degrees F. Stuff the sausage mixture into the mushroom caps. Place the mushrooms in a baking dish and drizzle the chicken stock around them. Bake until cooked through, about 20-25 minutes.

— Enjoy · Diana Giammarco

Lil's Sweet Italian Sausage Meatballs

Ingredients and notes

- 2 lbs. Ricci's sweet Italian sausage, bulk
- 1 egg
- ½ cup Parmesan cheese
- 1 cup breadcrumbs (unseasoned)
- 1 cube chicken bouillon

Directions

Prepare sweet Italian sausage in a bowl. Dissolve chicken bouillon in 1 cup of water. Pour dissolved chicken bouillon into bowl, add cheese and breadcrumbs. Mix thoroughly with the sweet sausage. Roll into meatballs and bake on a cookie sheet at 350 degrees for approximately 40 minutes. Makes approximately 10 meatballs. Double recipe for larger quantities.

— Lil Ricci · Ricci's Italian Sausage

Hot Sausage Soup

Ingredients and notes

- I have had the privilege of cooking with Chris Fennimore on QED Cooks since 1998. On behalf of the Cigna and The Little Sisters, we want to thank Chris for taking time to submit one of his signature recipes.
- 1 1/2 lb. Hot Italian sausage
- 1 large onion
- 1 green pepper
- 1 red pepper
- 1 - 28oz can crushed tomatoes
- 1 - 28oz can water
- 4 cloves garlic
- salt & pepper
- bay leaf
- 2 - 15oz cans cannellini beans
- 1 bunch greens (escarole, mustard, kale, etc.)

Directions

Over medium high heat, sauté the sausage in one-half cup water in a large sauce pot until the water dissolves and the sausage is browned on all sides. While they are frying, pierce the sausage in several places with a fork to release some of the fat. Remove the sausage and cut into one-half inch rounds. Chop the onion and peppers into one-half inch chunks and fry in the same pan until they are tender. Put the sausage rounds back in the pot and use a food mill to strain the crushed tomatoes into the pot. Add 1 can of water and the garlic cloves and bring to a boil, then lower to a simmer. Cook uncovered for about 1 and one-half hours. Add one can of the beans, drained and rinsed. Puree the other can of beans and add to the soup along with the greens, washed and chopped into bite-size pieces. Simmer for another 15 minutes until the greens are tender and serve with hunks of crusty bread. It's also nice to sprinkle each serving with a generous helping of grated Romano cheese.

— SUBMITTED BY: Chris Fennimore, WQED

Anna Cigna's Oven Spaghetti

Ingredients and notes

- Mix in large saucepan - Heat low until warm.
- Two (2) 48 oz. jars Ragu Spaghetti sauce
- Two (2) 15 oz. cans Condimento Per Pasta Con Sarde
- Two (2) 15 oz. cans Sardines in tomato sauce
- - make sure to de-bone the sardines
- - make sure to use sardines in tomato sauce
- Note: to have extra sauce, use 3 of each of the above instead of 2.

Directions

Boil 2 pounds of Broccoli and 2 pounds of Cauliflower for 7 minutes - drain and season

Boil 2 pounds of #8 spaghetti

In large baking dish - layer ingredients

- Sauce - cover bottom of pan
- Spaghetti
- Sauce (less than first layer - enough to color spaghetti)
- Broccoli and Cauliflower
- Repeat as necessary
- Topping

Topping: Melt one (1) stick of butter in large skillet. Mix in 15 oz. container of Italian Bread crumbs. Completely cover spaghetti with topping (a layer of spaghetti and sauce should be at top to be covered by topping.)

Cover with foil - bake at 350 degrees to heat (Remember it's already cooked.) Take foil off half way through to brown topping.

Serve with Ernie Ricci's Hot & Sweet Sausage for a complete meal!

— Anna Cigna

Hot Sausage Casserole

Ingredients and notes

- When you visit Janoski's Farm and Greenhouse in Clinton, PA., you must cross the street and eat at Janoski's Country Restaurant. Sonny and Jo Ann created an amazing restaurant serving country style meals that won't leave you hungry! This one is a favorite!
- 5 LBS Ricci's hot Italian sausage bulk
- 2 large red peppers
- 1 large onion
- 1 tsb. fresh basil
- 2 lg. cans tomato paste
- 3 cups beef broth
- ½ cup Romano Cheese
- 1 cup shredded cheese

Directions

Brown sausage, peppers, and onions in a pot. Add fresh basil, tomato paste, and beef broth. Simmer for 15 minutes. Stir in Romano cheese. Cook your favorite pasta and stir in how sausage sauce. Top with shredded cheese and enjoy!

Rick DiCenzo

Janoski's Country Kitchen

Clinton, PA.

Sausage Lasagna

Ingredients and notes

- This is another great recipe from Chef Meg at T-Bone's Marketplace in Wexford. The combination of ground beef, veal, hot and sweet Italian sausage really adds flavor!
- ¼ Cup Olive Oil ½ lb. Ground Beef
- ½ lb. Ground Veal
- ½ lb. Ground Sweet Sausage
- 1 lb. Ground Hot Sausage
- 2 tsp. Garlic
- ¼ tsp. Oregano
- 2 TBLSP. Tomato Paste
- One (1) 28 ounce Can Diced Tomatoes
- Two (2) 28 ounce Cans Tomato Puree
- 3 lbs. Ricotta Cheese
- 1 Bunch Parsley, Chopped
- 1 Bunch Basil, Chopped
- 1 Cup Parmesan Cheese
- 2 Cups Shredded Provolone Cheese
- 2 Eggs
- Lasagna Noodles
- Salt & Pepper

Directions

In large pot, HEAT olive oil. Add beef, veal and sausage – Cook until browned. Add garlic, oregano, and tomato paste. COOK until meat is coated. ADD diced tomatoes and tomato puree. SIMMER until thickened. SEASON with salt and pepper.

In large bowl, COMBINE ricotta with eggs, basil, parsley, parmesan cheese, and 1 lb. provolone cheese. BOIL Lasagna noodles. DRAIN and RINSE in cold water. Pat dry with a towel.

SPREAD 1 cup sauce in bottom of a 13x9 pan. Line with noodles. SPREAD 1/3 of ricotta mixture over noodles. Then TOP with 1 ½ cups of the sauce, and another layer of noodles. REPEAT this two (2) more times. Top with noodles and cover with remaining sauce. Sprinkle the remaining provolone cheese on top.

BAKE covered at 350 Degrees for 45 minutes to 1 hour, or until internal temperature is 145 Degrees. Let the lasagna rest for 15-20 minutes before serving.

— Meg Wendel · T-Bone's Marketplace · Wexford, PA

Baked Zucchini and Sausage

Ingredients and notes

- 4 cups zucchini (thinly sliced) –About 4 Zucchiniis
- 1 ½ cups biscuit mix
- ½ of a sweet onion (thinly sliced)
- ¾ cup of Parmesan cheese
- 2 tablespoons of fresh herbs chopped
- Parsley, oregano, basil or your choice
- ½ teaspoon salt
- 5 eggs (beaten)
- 1½ cups of shredded cheese—mozz/cheddar—or your choice
- 1 lb of loose sausage—cooked and drained—see below

Directions

Mix all together except cooked sausage

Bake in greased glass baking pan

Sprinkle top with Parmesan cheese

Bake till golden brown

Cooking time: 45 minutes

Temp: 350 degrees

Serving: 6-8

Pan Size: 21/2x9x15-inch

Mix all together except sausage (add cooked sausage on top of baked zucchini –10 minutes before removing from oven)

— I use my Food Processor for all the slicing and beating of the eggs · I know you will really enjoy this recipe --- Patty Walker

Big Dee's Fourth of July Sausage

Ingredients and notes

- 100 pounds of Ricci's link sausage green peppers onions garlic Red Pack tomato sauce
12 dozen Mancini "special" rolls

Directions

Directions -Boil sausage in large pots, skim top. When done cut into 6 inch long lengths. -In the meantime, sauté sliced green peppers; sweet onions and garlic in olive oil (inhale the scent...heaven!). Add tomato sauce. -Add sausage into the sauce mixture and cook in an electric roaster pan all day on 250 degrees (again, inhale...OMG so good!) -Slice Mancini rolls and fill with sausage, peppers and onions. -Invite 300 of your close friends and relatives to enjoy the best sausage in the USA! Recipe compliments of the family of Dominic T. Roppa

— In memory of Big Dee who loved the Fourth of July celebrations and Ricci's Sausage

Cliff's Sausage Recipe

Ingredients and notes

- I'm Cliff Ridilla from Cliff's Carpet in Latrobe. I was a Cigna Rider and Carmine's friend for many years. Every year John came to our company picnic for the sausage. So, here is the recipe!
- Get a big cast iron pot with a lid
- Throw in 2 lbs cut up chicken breast
- 2 big red onions cut up and fry in olive oil til brown
- Throw in 2lbs cut up hot sausage
- 6 clove garlic, fry 3 minutes
- Now throw in 1 can chic broth and 1 can tomato paste
- 1 can rotel
- 4 jalapeno peppers cut up
- 2 cups red wine 2 cups brown rice or zatarans

Directions

Cook low and slow for 20 minutes and add little water or beer if it gets dry

Now, cut up a red and yellow sweet pepper, a handful of fresh spinach and a pound of scallops or shrimp. Throw it all in, salt, pepper, and red hot to taste.

5 minutes and it's done!

MANGIA! MANGIA!

— Cliff Ridilla · Cliff's Carpet · Latrobe, PA · Cigna Rider

Death by Garlic Steak (or Sausage)!

Ingredients and notes

- Working with John Cigna over the years was always fruitful and fun! Raising funds for "The Little Sisters of the Poor" is something we did with a passion. Our secret goal was to raise enough money to enable the Sisters to change their name to "The Little Sisters of the Lower Middle Class!" I hope this recipe helps them to continue their worthy mission.
- Start by wrapping some Idaho potatoes in aluminum foil and bake for one hour @ 375 degrees.

Directions

Next, take two or three whole bulbs of garlic. Separate and peel to yield about 50 cloves. Pour one cup extra virgin olive oil into a frying pan. While the oil is heating, slightly bruise the garlic cloves. (I use the bottom of a large ceramic coffee mug.) This will help to release the savory juice inside the cloves... As soon as the oil is nice and hot, toss in the garlic. Let it cook for two or three minutes until golden brown. Care must be taken not to burn or over cook the cloves. Remove from oil and let cool. Save the garlic infused olive oil and let cool for use in the salad dressing.

Next, toss a field green salad with fresh garden tomatoes, whole fresh basil leaves and those little buds from the tip of the basil plant. Add Bermuda onion, mozzarella chunks, black olives, and a sprig of finely chopped parsley and, a sprig of finely chopped oregano.

Option #1: Squeeze the juice on one lemon into the cooled oil. Then, salt and pepper to taste. Now toss it into the salad. Add a splash of white wine for flavor and to help emulsify the lemon juice with the olive oil.

Option #2: Add ¼ cup of balsamic vinegar instead of lemon juice... Red wine instead of white.

Don't forget to save some of that wine for dinner, but keep tasting it to make sure it is o.k. to serve to your guests!

You might want to start broiling some New York Strips or nice Delmonico steaks.** (See footnote) They'll be ready before you finish your second glass of wine...

Place a sizzling steak on each plate and top with a generous mound of the golden garlic cloves on top of the steak.

Serve with baked potato (Brush some of the garlic oil on the potato then, add butter and sour cream.)

Steamed broccoli is also a welcome side dish that will add some color to the plate, and to your cheeks.

The cure for garlic breath is nonexistent. However, if everyone partakes, it is somehow neutralized.

My suggestion for dinner music would have to be Cigna's favorite band, Jimmy Sapienza's Five Guys Named MOE™. (Drop me an email and order a copy of our latest CD if you don't already have one.)

Email: jimmy.sapienza@verizon.net Remember... Good music always promotes good digestion!

Mangia bene!

— **PS: This recipe also works by replacing the steak with Ricci's sausage... · Because Hot or Sweet... Ricci's Sausage Is Always A Treat

Fast and Easy Pasta Surprise

Ingredients and notes

- This is a super easy and fast meal to prepare for the person who is really on the go and doesn't have much time left to cook. Also, the leftovers are delicious!
- 1 lb. Hot or Sweet Ricci's Italian Bulk Sausage
- 1 lb. small pasta shells
- 1 lb. sliced provolone cheese
- 1 lb. sliced mozzarella cheese
- 1 cup sour cream
- 1 quart spaghetti sauce

Directions

Brown and drain sausage. Cook pasta shells. Pour a third of the sauce into a 9x13" pan. Layer half of the pasta shells over the sauce, then cover with half of the cooked sausage and cover that with a layer of half of the sliced provolone cheese, sour cream, and half of the sliced mozzarella cheese and 3 cups of spaghetti sauce. Continue to layer the rest of the shells, sausage, provolone cheese, spaghetti sauce and mozzarella cheese. Bake at 350 degrees for 30 minutes.

— Judy Yanke-Fritzges · Former Producer of the John Cigna Show

Jambalaya

Ingredients and notes

- 12 medium shrimp, peeled, deveined & chopped
- 1 deboned chicken breast, cubed
- *New Orleans seasoning*
- 1 tsp paprika
- 1 tsp salt
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 1/2 tsp pepper
- 1/2 tsp onion powder
- 1/2 tsp cayenne pepper
- 1/2 tsp dried oregano
- 1/2 tsp dried thyme

Directions

Mix together and store tightly covered

2 tbs olive oil

1/4 cup chopped onion

1/4 cup chopped celery

1/4 cup chopped green pepper

2 tbs minced garlic

1/2 cup chopped tomato

2 bay leaves

1tsp Worcestershire sauce

1 tsp hot sauce or to taste

3/4 cup rice

3 cups chicken stock

1/2 pound Andouille sausage, sliced

In bowl combine shrimp, chicken and 1 Tbs of New Orleans Seasoning (or substitute Old Bay). Stir to coat well. In large sauce pan heat oil and add onion, pepper and celery. Cook for about 3 minutes. Add garlic, tomatoes, bay leaves, Worcestershire and hot sauce. Stir in rice. Slowly add broth. Keep heat at medium and cook until rice absorbs liquid and is just tender, stirring occasionally for about 15 minutes. Add shrimp & chicken mixture and sausage. Cook until meat is done, about 10 minutes. Season to taste with salt, pepper and more New Orleans Seasoning and/or hot sauce.

— Dave & Pam Finney · Cigna Rider

Breakfast Bake

Ingredients and notes

- 1 loaf bread, Italian or other crusty bread, can be fresh or stale, cut into cubes
- Bulk sausage, breakfast, Italian, your choice

Directions

Sauté in pan until just cooked through and in crumbly pieces. Drain well on paper towels.

In large bowl, beat together 5 eggs and 2 cups milk.

Put bread in bowl and toss. Refrigerate overnight.

In morning, add sautéed sausage and 1 cup grated cheese (Your choice of cheese. Suggestions: Cheddar with Breakfast sausage, mozzarella with Italian) to bread/egg mixture.

Butter casserole/ cake pan large enough to hold mix. Pour mix into pan. Top with additional cheese &/or bread crumbs and bits of butter.

Bake at 350 for 45 minutes.

Cut into squares and serve.

— Dave & Pam Finney · Cigna Riders

Nona's Thanksgiving Stuffing

Ingredients and notes

- You will need
- 2.5 lbs Italian Sweet Sausage (bulk) 1 lb. ground meat 2 loaves of white bread 1.5 cups of finely chopped walnuts whole garlic glove Italian seasoning Directions:

Directions

Chop the garlic very fine In large sauté pan, sauté ground meat and sausage add garlic Sprinkle Italian seasoning over the top of meat mixture and stir Sautee until meat is thoroughly cooked Cube bread: if possible cube the day before Mix sausage mixture with bread and add water to moisten (very small amounts at a time as to not soak the bread) add chopped walnuts and mix You are now ready to stuff the bird. We also use this same stuffing at Christmas for Stuffed Chicken Marsala!! Maryann Butler Bobby D's Catering

Risotto With Sausage, Sun-Dried Tomatoes And Escarole

Ingredients and notes

- This is a great recipe from Jon Burnett, KDKA TV-2 and Cigna Rider. Jon made many visits to The Little Sisters of the Poor with John Cigna to visit with the residents. This is a great recipe!
- 3 T. olive oil
- 1 c. escarole, coarsely chopped
- 1 lb. hot Italian sausage
- ½ tsp. ground black pepper
- 6 sun-dried tomatoes, finely diced
- 1 c. grated Parmesan cheese, divided
- 1 small yellow onion, finely diced
- ¼ tsp. ground nutmeg
- 1 ½ cups Arborio rice or barley
- 1 handful fresh basil, chopped
- 5 cups hot chicken stock

Directions

Heat 1 T. olive oil in skillet and cook sausage, breaking it into small pieces, until browned. Remove with slotted spoon. Add sun-dried tomatoes to sausage and set aside. Add remaining 2 T. olive oil. Cook onion over medium heat until softened, about 3-5 minutes. Add rice or barley and cook 2 minutes, stirring constantly. Add enough chicken stock to just cover rice or barley/onion mixture. Cook over medium-high heat until liquid is absorbed. Repeat this step until all broth is used. Lower heat to low. Add tomatoes and sausage, escarole, black pepper, ¾ c. Parmesan cheese, and nutmeg. Cook until heated throughout and escarole is wilted. Garnish with remaining Parmesan and basil.

— Serves 4 · JON BURNETT · KDKA TV-2 · CIGNA RIDER

Provençal Stuffed Zucchini

Ingredients and notes

- 4 small zucchini
- 1 -2 cups marinara sauce
- Salt and black pepper
- 1/8 c. dry bread crumbs
- Extra virgin olive oil
- 1/8 c. Parmesan cheese
- 4 hot Italian sausage links

Directions

Preheat oven to 350. Cut the top ¼ of each zucchini off. Hollow each zucchini out, leaving about ¼ inch on sides and bottom. Lightly salt the zucchini "boats" and set aside, cut-side down on paper towels. Remove the stems from the zucchini tops along with the zucchini that you hollowed out. Heat a little olive oil in a skillet. Add sausage and sauté as you break the sausage up. Add onion and cook until soft. Add diced zucchini and season with salt and pepper. Cook until the zucchini is soft. Add marinara sauce and cook 2 minutes. Add ½ of the bread crumbs. Spray a baking dish with cooking spray. Pat dry the insides of the zucchini boats and fill with diced zucchini mixture. Sprinkle with Parmesan cheese and the remaining bread crumbs. Bake 30 minutes.

— Serves 4 · JON BURNETT · KDKA TV-2 · CIGNA RIDER

Sausage Dip

Ingredients and notes

- Italian
- Ingredients:
- 8oz. block Cream cheese
- 16oz. jar Chi Chi's Salsa
- Cup chopped onions
- Cup chopped green peppers
- Cups shredded Mozzarella Cheese
- lb. Ricci's loose Hot Sausage
- Mancini's bread sticks
- Procedure:

Directions

See ingredients and notes above; this source recipe has no explicit Directions label.

— Brown sausage in skillet · Soften cream cheese and spread on the bottom of a 9x13 glass dish · Spread sausage over the cream cheese · Cover with a layer of salsa then onions and peppers · Top with Mozzarella · Cover with aluminum foil · Bake @ 350 for 40 minutes or until middle bubbles · Slice bread into thin slices · Spread dip on to bread · Mexican · Same as above but substitute: · Shredded Cheddar for Mozzarella · Sweet Sausage for the Hot Sausage · Nacho Chips for the Bread · Doria Martinelli · Kennedy Township

Sausage Balls

Ingredients and notes

- 2 C Bisquick
- 1 lb. bulk hot sausage
- ½ lb. shredded sharp cheddar cheese

Directions

Mix together. Roll into ¾- to 1-inch balls. Bake 20-30 minutes at 350 degrees

Greg Jena

Former Director of Marketing & Promotion when John Cigna was on the morning show!

Sausage Rustica

Ingredients and notes

- Make pizza dough:
- 1 package yeast
- 2/3 c warm water
- 3/4 teaspoon salt
- 2 cups flour
- 1 tablespoon olive oil
- Combine yeast and warm water in large bowl
- Let stand 5 minutes. Add flour, salt and olive oil. Work mixture into a dough. Knead until smooth. Cover with dish towel and place in warm place about 45 minutes or until double in bulk. Punch down.
- 3/4 Ricci's hot or sweet sausage
- 3/4 mozzarella sliced
- 1/2 c marinara sauce
- 1/2 teaspoon dried oregano
- 1 package frozen spinach thawed and drained
- 1 beaten egg
- 1/4 pound pepperoni sliced
- 12-15 large green olives with pimentos

Directions

Cook sausages, leave in slices long enough to fit in a bread loaf pan.

Roll 3/4 dough on lightly floured board and line 8 1/2 x 4 1/2 x 2 1/2 lightly greased loaf pan, moisten dough on edges to seal.

place 1/3 mozzarella in bottom of pan, top with sausages. Spoon sauce over sausage and sprinkle with oregano.

Combine spinach with egg and layer next in pan. Add remaining cheese, pepperoni and add olives across top [should cover the pan]

Roll out remaining dough and cover filling. Cut a few slits on top. Bake 400. 50-60 minutes until crust is golden brown. Let cool pop out of pan. Slice. Makes a beautiful presentation!

— Cynthia Volpe · Pittsburgh Post-Gazette

Spaghetti Pie

Ingredients and notes

- 6 oz. spaghetti 1 c. cottage cheese
- 2 Tbsp. margarine or butter 1 lb. sausage (or ground meat)
- 1/3 c. Parmesan cheese 1/4 c. chopped green pepper
- 2 eggs, well beaten 1 (6 oz.) can tomato paste
- 1 (8 oz.) can tomatoes, cut up 1 tsp. oregano
- 1 tsp. sugar 1/2 c. Mozzarella cheese
- 1/2 tsp. garlic powder 1/2 c. chopped onion

Directions

Cook spaghetti and drain. Stir butter into hot spaghetti, Parmesan cheese, and eggs. Form spaghetti mixture into crust shape in greased 10-inch pie plate. Spread cottage cheese over bottom crust. Cook ground meat, onion, and pepper until tender and meat browned. Drain. Stir in undrained tomatoes, tomato paste, sugar, oregano, and garlic powder. Heat through. Turn meat and sauce mixture into spaghetti crust. Bake uncovered at 350 for 20 minutes. Sprinkle Mozzarella cheese on top. Bake 5 minutes longer. Serves 6.

— Joann Grieco · Cigna Rider

Broccoli di Rabe (Rapini) with Sausage

Ingredients and notes

- 2 lbs Broccoli di Rabe
- Blanch in boiling water until tender.
- Shock in ice bath to maintain green color.
- 2 oz Extra Virgin Olive Oil (Claudio's preference – Colavita)
- 1 oz Chopped Fresh Garlic
- ¾ lb Hot Sausage (Ricci's)
- Dash of Butter
- Salt and Pepper

Directions

Brown garlic in olive oil with cut up sausage.

Add broccoli di rabe.

Salt and Pepper to taste.

Add a little water and a dash of butter.

Put a lid on for 2 minutes.

Toss & serve.

— Chef Claudio Masci · Claudio's Ristorante

Chicken Scarpiello

Ingredients and notes

- This is a wonderful family recipe from Gaetano, Rita and Joey DiSalvo from DiSalvo's Station in Latrobe. Joey DiSalvo cooked for the Spaghetti Breakfast with John Cigna in Market Square when we hit our record crowd of 4,000 people!
- 3 ½ lbs. chicken breasts cut up in bite size pieces
- 2 ½ lbs. Ricci's sweet Italian sausage cut up in bite size pieces
- 2 tsp. minced garlic
- 1 tsp. crushed rosemary
- 1 tsp. salt
- 1 tsp. pepper
- ¼ tsp. red pepper flakes
- 1 tsp. minced basil
- 1 tsp. minced parsley
- 4 tbsp. extra virgin olive oil
- ¾ cup wine
- 1 can whole tomatoes in juice

Directions

In a sauté pan over medium heat, add 2 tbsp. olive oil. Add sausage and cook for 10 minutes and put aside. In a clean pan, sauté chicken in 2 tbsp. olive oil till golden. Add garlic and sauté till pale gold. Add rosemary, salt, pepper, red pepper flakes, and ¾ cup wine. Add tomatoes (tear in pieces with your hands) and add basil. Add sausage and let it simmer for about 30 minutes till juice is reduced in half and chicken is cooked.

Serve in a large platter and garnish with parsley. Serve with something starchy to soak up the sauce! The very best thing that goes with it is polenta.

Polenta ½ pound (polenta is the Italian version of corn meal)

3 cups water

2 tsp. salt

Bring water and salt to boil. Pour in the polenta in a steady stream, turning it rapidly with a heavy wooden spoon down to the bottom of the pot, from side to side to the center and back to the sides. Reduce heat to simmering point. Keep stirring firmly until the polenta is done, about 40 minutes. Pour the polenta in a pile in a large platter. Make a well in the middle of it and pour some of the sauce. Arrange the chicken and sausage around it and spoon the rest of the sauce over the chicken and polenta!

— Gaetano, Rita and Joey DiSalvo · DiSalvo's Station · Latrobe, PA

Italian Egg Casserole

Ingredients and notes

- 1lb- Ricci's Italian sausage (fried, crumbled and drained)
- 5-slices Italian bread
- 1-medium onion sautéed
- 1-green pepper sautéed
- 2-cups shredded cheddar cheese
- 10-eggs
- 2- Cups milk
- salt/pepper

Directions

Preheat oven to 350 degrees. Spray 9x13 pan with Pam.

Mix eggs, milk, salt and pepper with a whisk; set aside. Line bottom of baking dish with bread cover with sausage, onions, peppers and cheese; Pour egg mixture evenly over top of casserole and bake at 350 degrees for 45-50min.

— Kelli Priddy

Breakfast Sausage & Egg Soufflé'

Ingredients and notes

- 9 eggs
- 3 C Milk
- 9 slices of white bread (remove crusts)
- 1-1/2 C of shredded cheddar cheese
- 1-1/2 tsp of salt
- 1-1/2 tsp dry mustard
- 1-1/2 lb. of bulk sausage (mild or hot)
- 1/2 medium diced onion
- Chopped jalapenos (optional - if you like spicy include)

Directions

Crumble and slightly brown sausage with onions. Drain and cool. In mixing bowl, beat eggs, milk, salt, and mustard. Cube bread; stir in mixture. Add cheese, sausage, and onions. Pour into 9x13 inch glass baking dish (spray dish with cooking spray) and refrigerate overnight. Remove from refrigerator 1/2 hour before baking. Sprinkle with paprika. Bake 45 minutes at 350 degrees.

— CIGNA RIDER - ANONYMOUS

Breakfast Pizza

Ingredients and notes

- 1 lb. bulk sausage (mild or hot)
- 1 (8 oz.) pkg. refrigerated crescent rolls
- 1 C frozen loose-pack hash brown potatoes (thawed)
- 1 C shredded cheddar cheese
- 3 large eggs, beaten
- 1/4 C milk
- 2 Tbsp grated parmesan cheese
- 1/3 small chopped onion
- 1/8 tsp salt
- 1/8 tsp pepper

Directions

Crumble and cook sausage until brown. Drain. Set aside.

Separate crescent dough and shape into round crust on pizza pan (spray pan with cooking spray). Spoon sausage over dough; sprinkle with hash browns, onion, and cheddar cheese. Combine eggs, milk, salt, and pepper and pour over sausage mixture. Bake at 375 degrees for about 25 minutes. Sprinkle with parmesan cheese and bake an additional 5 to 10 minutes on 350 degrees.

— CIGNA RIDER - ANONYMOUS

Italian Sausage Stuffed Peppers With Provolone

Ingredients and notes

- 4 cups water
- 1 tablespoon salt
- 1 cup orzo*
- 12 ounces fresh Italian sausage, either hot or mild
- 1 cup roasted red peppers, drained and chopped
- 1 cup (4 ounces) shredded Wisconsin Mozzarella Cheese
- 1 cup (4 ounces) shredded Wisconsin Provolone Cheese
- 8 large fresh whole red peppers, tops sliced off and seeded
- ¼ cup fresh bread crumbs
- 2 tablespoons homemade or purchased basil pesto

Directions

Preheat oven to 400 degrees F.

Bring water to a boil in a large, deep pot. Add salt and orzo. Boil for 9 minutes. Drain in wire sieve and rinse with cold water. Drain again. Set aside.

Remove sausage from casings, if necessary, and break into small pieces. Sauté over medium high heat until browned and barely cooked through. Add chopped red peppers. Remove from heat and stir in orzo and cheeses until cheese melts. Cool.

Coat a 13 x 9-inch baking pan with cooking spray.

Stuff sausage-orzo mixture into prepared whole peppers and place peppers upright in the pan.

Mix bread crumbs and pesto together and spread evenly over top of the stuffed peppers.

Cover with foil and bake for 45 minutes. Remove foil and bake an additional 15 minutes or until the surface is lightly browned.

Serve immediately.

*Orzo is a dried pasta, shaped like short-grain rice.

— Anonymous Pittsburgh Italian

Aglione With Sausage

Ingredients and notes

- A simple pasta dish that uses old world flavors for your modern day family. This is traditional pasta dish only has a handful of ingredients but is big on flavor.
- 1-1/2 lbs. of sausage meat
- 1 lb. of dry pasta
- ½ cup of olive oil
- 5 cloves of minced garlic
- 1 tsp. of salt
- 2 Tbsp. of fresh parsley
- 2 Tbsp. of grated cheese
- Pinch of red pepper flakes (optional)

Directions

You will need two pots to make this dish, a large pot to boil the water and also a medium size pot for all of the other ingredients. Begin by boiling your water for your pasta, do not add salt. It will only make the water take longer to boil. In your other pot add a little bit of oil to coat the bottom of the pan on low heat. Add to the warm oil your minced garlic and sausage meat. (Use your favorite brand of sausage but remove it from the casing so that it will cook fast evenly.) Stir frequently to avoid burning your garlic or meat to the bottom of the pot. Once the meat has cooked through (about 8 to 10 minutes), you can raise the heat slightly and add in the rest of your oil, salt, parsley and grated cheese. At this point your water should be ready for your pasta. Add your pasta and cook it to the directions on the package. While waiting for the pasta to finish cooking, stir your sausages, oil and other ingredients to avoid anything sticking to the bottom of the pot. Drain your pasta when ready and combine it with your other ingredients into a large bowl to serve. If the pasta soaks up all of the oil you can add a little bit more oil to the dish and toss it all together. Sprinkle some grated cheese on top and enjoy.

— Cook Time: 20 Min · Servings 4 · Anonymous Pittsburgh Italian

Sausage Rolls

Ingredients and notes

- 1 batch of pizza dough
- (or frozen bread dough)
- 1 1/2 lb. Ground pork
- 1 TBS fennel seed
- 1 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp pepper
- 1 cup grated provolone cheese
- 1 cup grated mozzarella cheese
- 1/2 cup grated Romano cheese
- 1 TBS red pepper flakes (optional)
- paprika (optional)

Directions

Sauté the ground pork until it is well browned. Drain excess fat if necessary. Allow to cool slightly then add the fennel seeds, spices and cheeses. Cut the dough into bun-size pieces. Flatten each piece into a roughly round shape and top with 2 TBS of the meat/cheese mixture. Fold the bottom edge toward the middle, tuck in the two sides and continue to roll up until you have enclosed the mixture. Pinch the seam together and place seam side down on a greased or parchment covered baking sheet. Allow to rise for about 1/2 hour. Brush gently with olive oil and mark with a sprinkling of paprika if you have included the hot pepper flakes. Bake at 350 degrees for 20 minutes or until golden brown.

— Chris Fennimore, WQED

Easter Meat Pie

Ingredients and notes

- 1 package pie crust (2 crusts) 1 pound ricotta cheese 3 eggs 4 ounces mozzarella cheese, grated 1 pound sausage (or assorted cubed, cooked meats like ham, hot capicola, Genoa salami) 1/4 cup Parmesan cheese, grated

Directions

Preheat oven to 325 degrees. Place ricotta in a large mixing bowl and add eggs one at a time while mixing on low speed. Stir in mozzarella cheese and meat and mix well. Place one crust in a 9 inch pie pan. Pour the cheese mixture into the crust and top with the Parmesan cheese. Place the other crust over the cheese mixture and crimp the edges. Cut in steam vents in the top crust. Bake for 1 hour until the crust is golden brown. Let stand 20 minutes before serving. Can also be served at room temperature or cold. Can also be prepared as a meatless dish on Good Friday using 1 package frozen spinach and 1 cup of shredded zucchini instead of the cooked meats.

— Mary Funkhouser Holmes · Friend of John Cigna and The Cigna Riders

Easter Breakfast Casserole

Ingredients and notes

- 12 oz. Ricci's breakfast sausage links
- 6 English muffins cut in 1-in cubes
- ¼ cup melted butter
- 1 cup shredded cheddar cheese
- 1 cup shredded mozzarella
- ½ cup chopped onion ½ chopped red peppers
- 12 eggs
- 2 cups milk
- 1/2 tsp. salt
- 1/2 tsp. pepper
- 1/4-cup bacon bits

Directions

Cook sausage. Cool and cut into ¼ in. slices. Place English muffin cubes in a greased 13x9-baking dish; drizzle with butter. Layer sausage, cheese, onion and red pepper. In a large bowl, combine the eggs, milk, salt and pepper. Pour over layers in pan. Sprinkle with bacon. Cover and refrigerate overnight. Remove from refrigerator 30 minutes before baking. Uncover and bake at 350 for 45-50 minutes. Let stand 5 minutes. 12 servings (Irish). 6 Servings (Italian).

Dr. Pam Clarke, D.M.D.

— Robinson Township

Italian Easter Pie

Ingredients and notes

- 1/2 lb. bulk sausage, cooked
- 1 sm. onion, chopped
- 1/4 lb. chopped hard salami
- 1/4 lb. chopped pepperoni
- 1/4 lb. prosciutto, chopped
- 1 lb. basket cheese drained
- 4 oz. shredded mozzarella
- 4 oz. shredded provolone
- 1 lb. ricotta
- 1/4 cup Parmesan cheese
- 2 eggs Pastry for 2 crust pie

Directions

Place bottom crust into 9-inch pie pan

Prepare filling: cook sausage and chopped onions together. Chop meats.

Drain: basket cheese and crumble or slice into bite size pieces

Mix: all ingredients and put into pie crust

Put on top crust and pinch to seal edges

Bake: 350 for 50 minutes.

Dr. Pam Clarke, D.M.D.

— Robinson Township

Sausage Potato Bake

Ingredients and notes

- 1 lb. bulk pork sausage
- 1 can condensed (undiluted) can of cream of mushroom soup
- 3/4 cup of milk
- 1/4 cup chopped onion
- 3 cups sliced potatoes
- 1 cup shredded cheddar cheese

Directions

In a large skillet, cook sausage until no longer pink; drain

In a large bowl, combine soup, milk and onions

In a greased baking dish, layer 1/2 potatoes, soup mixture and sausage repeat layers

Cover and bake at 350 for 1-1/2 hrs. until potatoes are tender uncover and sprinkle with cheese. Bake a few min more until cheese is melted.

— Helga Petroff

Sausage Swiss Quiche

Ingredients and notes

- 1 ½ cups milk
- 3 eggs
- ½ cup Bisquick Mix
- ¼ teaspoon salt
- dash pepper
- 1 cup shredded Swiss cheese
- ½ cup Ricci's Sweet Sausage cooked and crumbled
- ½ cup melted butter or margarine

Directions

Blend all except meat and cheese on low speed for 3 minutes.

Pour into greased 9 inch pie pan or quiche pan.

Push gently below surface with back of spoon.

Bake at 350 degrees for 45 minutes.

Allow to set for 10 minutes before serving.

— Makes 6 to 8 servings · Mary Lynn Ocvirk · Robinson Township

Jambalaya

Ingredients and notes

- 2 Tbls vegetable oil
- 1 lb boneless chicken breast cut in 1 inch pieces
- 1 lb hot Italian sausage
- 2 cups onion – diced
- 1 cup celery – diced
- 1 cup green pepper – diced
- 3 cloves garlic – minced
- 1 tsp thyme
- ½ tsp black pepper
- ½ tsp basil
- ½ tsp cayenne pepper
- Salt to taste
- 4 cups chicken broth
- 1 lb medium shrimp – peeled and deveined
- 2 cups tomato sauce
- 2 cups rice

Directions

Heat the oil in an 8-quart Dutch oven.

Brown the chicken pieces and remove from the pan.

Add the sausage and brown well on all sides. The bottom of the pan will be covered by what Creole cooks call a “graton.” That’s all the stuff that sticks to the pan and comes off later to give a rich flavor to the dish.

Return the chicken to the pot and add the onions, celery, peppers and garlic.

Simmer for about 10 minutes until the onions are wilted.

Add the spices, chicken broth and tomato sauce.

Simmer for another 10 minutes.

Bring to a boil and add the shrimp. When the mixture comes back to the boil, add the uncooked rice.

Cover tightly, reduce the heat to low and allow it to cook for 15 minutes.

Lift the lid and fold the ingredients.

Cover again and let steam on low heat for another 10 minutes, until the rice is tender.

Serve right from the pot for a rustic presentation.

— Lynn Blumling Neuwirth · Robinson Township

Mangia!

Thank you for cooking with us.

Ricci's Italian Sausage
590 Pine Hollow Road
McKees Rocks, PA 15136
riccisausage.com

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